



ARLINGTON COUNTY, VIRGINIA

County Board Agenda Item Meeting of February 24, 2024

SUPPLEMENTAL REPORT-REVISED RECOMMENDATION & ORDINANCE

DATE: DATE: February 22, 2024

SUBJECT: Establishing Ranked Choice Voting As The Election Method For Arlington County's County Board 2024 General Election

DISCUSSION: This supplemental report does not change the intended effect of the uncoded ordinance, which is to establish Ranked Choice Voting (RCV) as the election method for the Arlington County Board 2024 general election. The purpose of this supplemental report is to remove language from the recommendation and resolution that is duplicative in nature. The previous recommendation language intended to limit the use of RCV to any one-seat race for the 2024 County Board general election. However, it has been determined that there are no situations in which a two-seat general election race could occur this year. Any County Board vacancies would either be handled via an appointment process or a separate special election race, depending on the timing of the vacancy. Thus, including additional language to restrict the effect of this ordinance to any one-seat race for the 2024 County Board general election is unnecessary and was removed.

RECOMMENDATION: Adopt the attached uncoded ordinance to establish Ranked Choice Voting as the election method for the November 2024 County Board general election, ~~which is currently a one seat election. This ordinance would not apply in the event that this election becomes a two seat election.~~

County Attorney:

MNC

Staff: David R. Barrera, CBO

APPENDIX A

ENACTMENT OF AN UNCODIFIED ORDINANCE TO ESTABLISH RANKED CHOICE VOTING IN THE 2024 COUNTY BOARD GENERAL ELECTION.

BE IT ORDAINED by the County Board of Arlington, Virginia, that the following uncoded ordinance is hereby enacted, and ranked choice voting is hereby adopted as the election method in the 2024 County Board General Election.

WHEREAS, ranked choice voting (RCV) means the method of casting and tabulating votes in which voters rank candidates in order of preference, tabulation proceeds in sequential rounds in which last-place candidates are defeated and the candidates with the most votes in the final round are nominated; and

WHEREAS, in July 2020, the Virginia General Assembly amended the Code of Virginia (§§ 15.2-705.1 and 24.2-673.1) to allow localities to implement RCV in elections of members of a county board under the County Manager plan of government, a county board of supervisors or a city council, and the decision to conduct an election by ranked choice voting shall be made, in consultation with the local electoral board and general registrar, by a majority vote of the board of supervisors or city council that the office being elected serves; and

WHEREAS, the Electoral Board and Registrar of Arlington County, Virginia have engaged in educational efforts since 2021, including conducting a mock election using the application of RCV, a work session with the Arlington County Board to introduce and establish familiarity among stakeholders of the process of RCV, and numerous training sessions since the adoption of RCV as the election method for the June 2023 County Board primary election; and

WHEREAS, the use of RCV in the June 2023 primary elections for Arlington County Board allowed for the introduction of this new method to our community, and the Office of Office of Elections reported no technical difficulty in administering this election; and

WHEREAS, the County Board adopted the use of RCV in all County Board primary elections at its December 2023 meeting; and

WHEREAS, the County Board adopting the pilot use of RCV in the upcoming 2024 County Board general election would introduce this new method to more of the voting population, allowing the Board to monitor and gauge its reception to help decide in future implementation in general elections; and

WHEREAS, state law provides that any changes to an election must occur at least 90 days before such election and with the passage of this resolution Arlington County is compliant, and adoption of this resolution more than four months before the general election allows the Arlington County Registrar additional time to educate and engage the community on the election method;

WHEREAS, this ordinance is only meant to apply to the expected one seat 2024 County Board general election. In the event that this general election becomes a two seat election, this ordinance will not apply.

NOW, THEREFORE, BE IT ORDAINED, that the County Board of Arlington County, Virginia, hereby establishes RCV as the election method **for any single seat race** for the 2024 County Board general election.

Adopted the 24th day of February 2024